Ruler and Line Plot

TEACHER KEY

2nd Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Measure pencils with an inch or centimeter ruler, including pencils that do not start at 0, and record each length on a line plot. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. A pencil starts at 0 and ends at 6 on the inch ruler. How long is it?

6 inches

2. A pencil starts at 2 and ends at 9 on the inch ruler. How long is it?

7 inches (9 − 2 = 7)

3. Is a centimeter or an inch longer? Which unit gives a bigger number for the same pencil?

An inch is longer. Centimeters give the bigger number.

4. A line plot has × marks at 3, 5, 5, 6 and 7 inches. How many pencils were measured?

5 pencils

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Explore more

5. On that line plot, which length is the most common?

5 inches

6. How much longer is the longest pencil (7 in) than the shortest (3 in)?

4 inches

Reflect

7. Reflect: Why do you count spaces on a ruler and not the marks?

Each space is one unit of length. Counting marks counts one too many.

Teacher notes

- Show a pencil that starts at 2 and ask why the end mark is not the length.
- After 8 measurements, ask questions about the line plot: most common length, longest minus shortest.
- Enter submits an answer; Next pencil gives a new length (the sequence is the same every time, so a class can work together).

Standards: 2.MD.A.1, 2.MD.D.9. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool's picture.